

Active Directory Lab – Part 3: User, Group and OU Management

Objective

The objective of this lab was to practise basic Active Directory administration by creating organisational units, domain users, and security groups. This included organising users into appropriate containers, assigning group membership, and verifying the configuration using both Active Directory Users and Computers and Command Prompt.

Lab Environment

This part of the lab used the adlab.local domain created in Part 2. The Windows Server virtual machine was acting as the domain controller, and Active Directory Users and Computers was used to manage domain objects.

The domain used for this lab was “adlab.local”, with the NetBIOS name “ADLAB”.

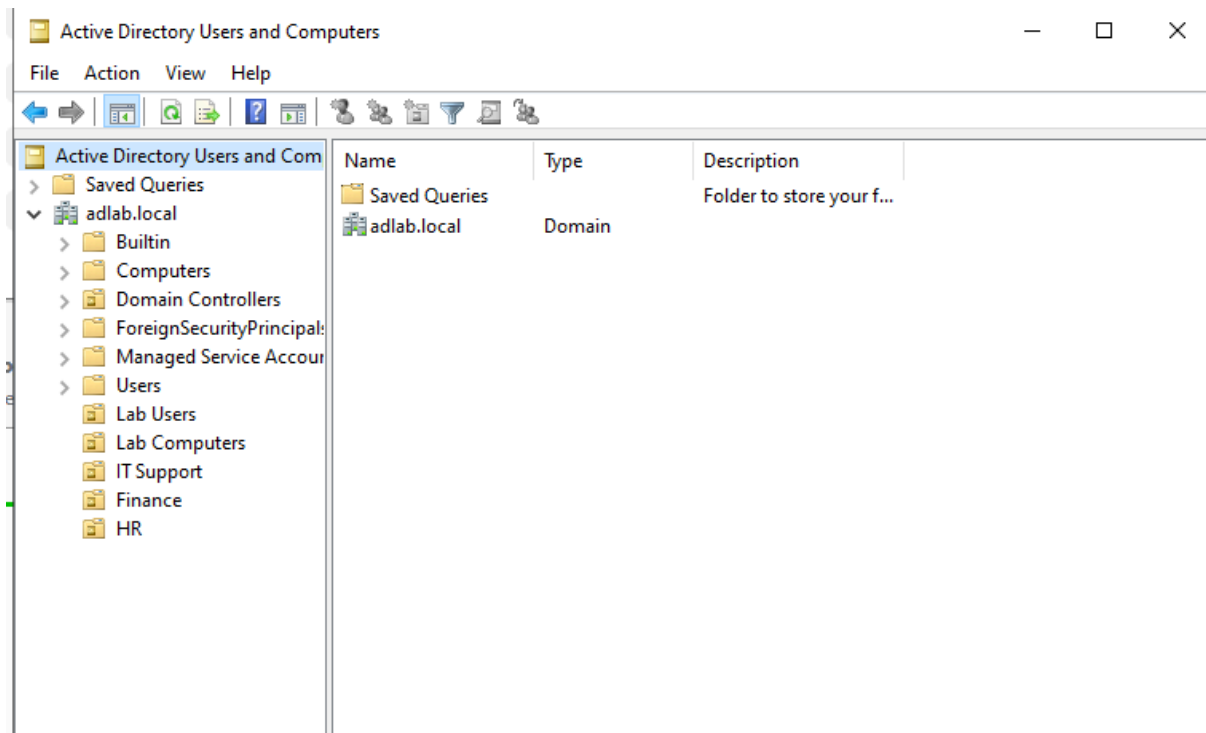
Tools Used:

- Windows Server 2022 Evaluation
- Active Directory Users and Computers
- Command Prompt

Steps Performed

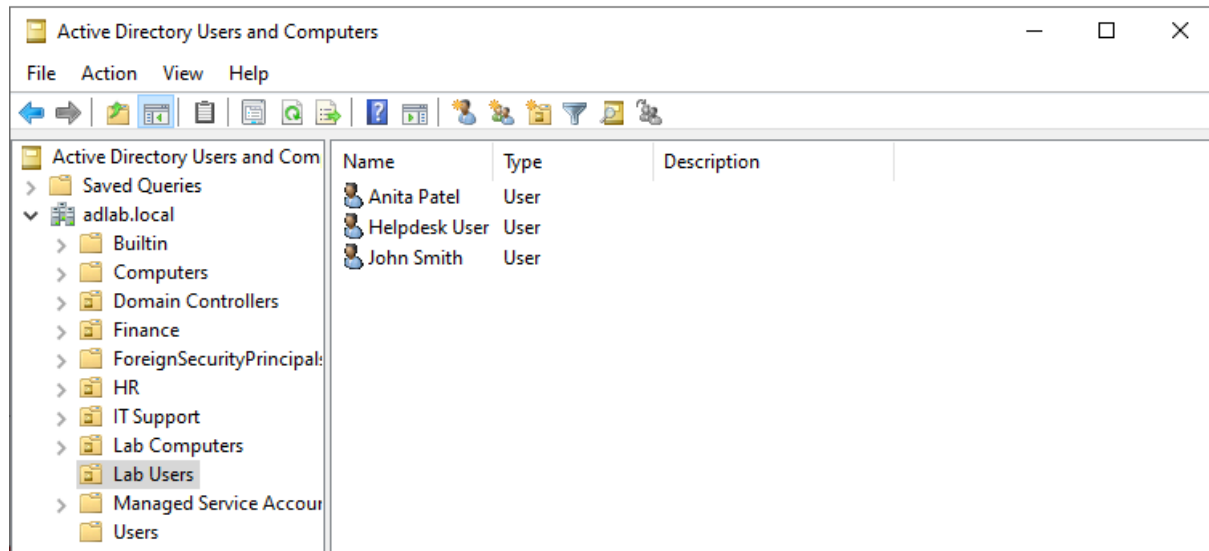
Active Directory Users and Computers was opened on the domain controller. Several organisational units were created under the adlab.local domain to provide a more structured layout for managing users, computers, and department-style groups.

The organisational units created included: Lab Users, Lab Computers, IT Support, Finance and HR.

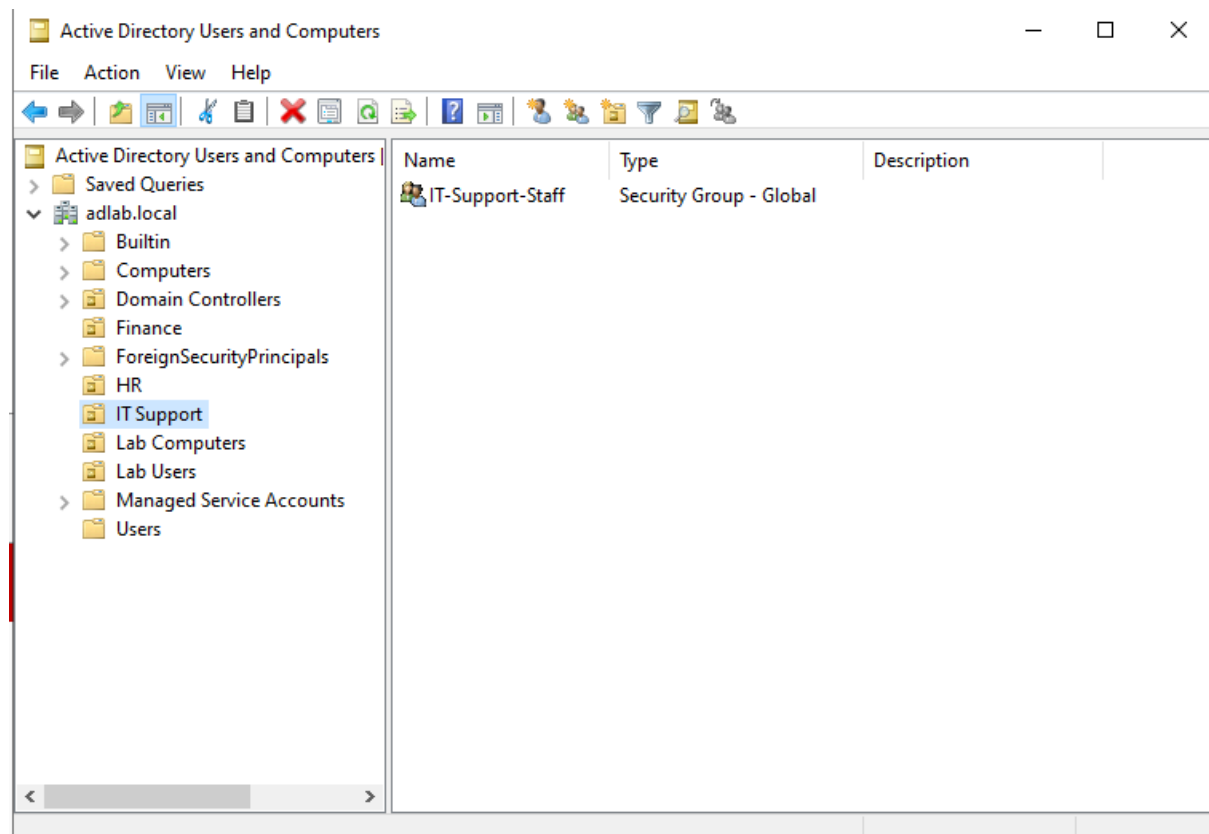


Test domain users were then created inside the Lab Users organisational unit. These users were created to simulate normal domain accounts that could later be used for login testing, group membership testing, and account lockout testing.

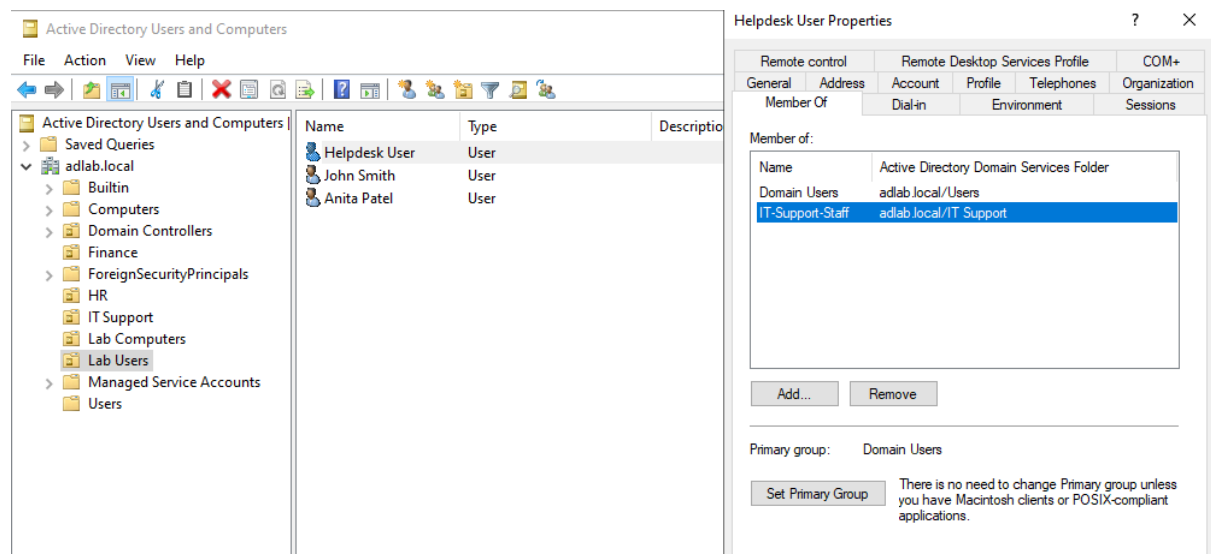
The users created were: John Smith, Anita Patel and Helpdesk User.



A security group called IT-Support-Staff was created inside the IT Support organisational unit. This group was configured as a global security group and was used to demonstrate basic Active Directory group membership management.



The Helpdesk User account was added to the IT-Support-Staff group. This demonstrated how users can be assigned to groups so that permissions, access, or policies can be managed more easily in a domain environment.



Command Prompt was then used to verify the configuration. The net user command confirmed that helpdesk.user was an active domain account and was a member of both IT-Support-Staff and Domain Users.

```
C:\Users\Administrator>net user helpdesk.user /domain
User name                helpdesk.user
Full Name                Helpdesk User
Comment
User's comment
Country/region code      000 (System Default)
Account active            Yes
Account expires           Never

Password last set        7/21/2026 7:11:36 AM
Password expires          Never
Password changeable       7/22/2026 7:11:36 AM
Password required         Yes
User may change password  Yes

Workstations allowed      All
Logon script
User profile
Home directory
Last logon               Never

Logon hours allowed       All

Local Group Memberships
Global Group memberships  *IT-Support-Staff    *Domain Users
The command completed successfully.
```

Findings

The organisational units, users, and security group were created successfully in Active Directory. The domain structure became more organised after separating users, computers, and department-style groups into different organisational units.

The Helpdesk User account was successfully added to the IT-Support-Staff group. This was confirmed through Active Directory Users and Computers and through Command Prompt using the net user command.

This showed how Active Directory can be used to organise users and groups in a way that supports easier administration, access control, and future Group Policy management.

Conclusion

This part of the lab demonstrated basic Active Directory user, group, and organisational unit management. Domain users were created, organised into OUs, added to a security group, and verified using both graphical and command-line tools. These are common tasks in IT support, service desk, and system administration environments.